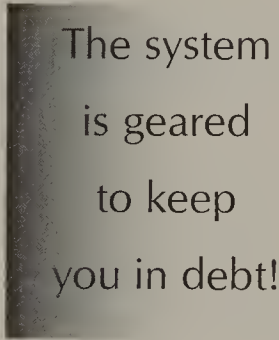


government of this country, is partly to blame. Over the last three decades, the consumer lending industry has spiraled out of control. And the United States federal government has let it happen. In fact, they helped create the monster that is now eating the average American citizen alive. They're actually working with the banking industry, creating laws and regulations that allow the credit card companies to rip off the American citizen.



The system
is geared
to keep
you in debt!

Are you in debt? I see you nodding your head. Again, you are not the only one. It's the American way. The system is made to keep Americans in debt. We as a nation are carrying a balance of consumer debt to the tune of 2.4 trillion dollars. I don't know if I can carry that tune, and I am not sure if I know how to write out that many zeroes. The amount is even more staggering when you realize that figure does not include our home mortgages. Based on

the latest census statistics, that equates to \$8,000 of debt for every man, woman, and child living here in the United States. Let's assume the kiddies are not charge card-carrying consumers, not yet anyway, so that means the figure per adult is even higher. The number is not per household; it is per person. That is a heavy weight to bear. It is too much to bear, and the scales are out of balance, completely lopsided. They are in fact tipping out of control, and in favor of the credit card companies.

Ordinary People

Let's take a look into the life of an ordinary couple. Ed and Sue have been married for several years. They have two kids, a dog, a minivan, and a small house, but no white picket fence. Ed and Sue both work to make ends meet, and they do not live an extravagant lifestyle. Their money is spent on groceries, daycare, and paying their credit card bills. Like the average family, they have almost \$10,000 in credit card balances. Ed and Sue sat down together and looked at their bills. They knew they had to do something. Every month, they made payments, but the balances never seemed to get smaller. We'll be seeing a lot more of Ed and Sue in the coming pages.